

VOCABULARY FOR APPEARANCE: C1 LEVEL

I've got another vocabulary lesson that will surely give your vocab bank a well-deserved boost! Today, we're going to explore the exciting world of words and expressions related to appearance. Forget the basic stuff - we're diving deep into the advanced words that'll make you sound positively fluent. And don't worry, I've included a quiz at the end to reinforce all of the vocabulary you are about to learn.

Childhood

I have always had long hair, and my cascade of blonde hair made me look quite **angelic** when I was little. A quick chat with my parents would soon dispel that misconception. My brother was adorable (all children are cute!). He had these gorgeous **dimples** that people teased him about sometimes, but I always adored them.

● VOCABULARY

1) **angelic** /æn'dʒelɪk/ - like an angel - beautiful, good and kind

Ali had an angelic smile, and no one could stay angry with her for long.

2) **dimple** /'dɪmpl/ - a small crease or indentation next to your mouth or on your chin

Whenever she smiled, her dimples would appear, making her look even more charming.

● EXTRA VOCABULARY

cascade /kæ'skeɪd/ - a waterfall-like arrangement or flow of something

The cascade of autumn leaves from the tall oak tree created a vibrant tapestry on the garden floor.

to dispel /dɪ'spel/ - to make something, such as a belief or fear, disappear

The scientists conducted experiments to dispel the notion that the Earth was flat.



misconception /ˌmɪskən'sepʃn/ - a mistaken belief or understanding about something

There is a common misconception that eating carrots can improve your vision.

The Teenage Years

Like most people, my appearance was quite important to me back then. One of the first things I did when I turned 13 was grab a pair of **tweezers** and **pluck** my eyebrows into submission. I regret it so much!

I also used to compare myself to my friends a lot, and one of the sticking points was my **complexion**. As you can see, I'm pretty pale, and I used to be so jealous of my friends who would come back after the summer holidays totally **sun-kissed**.

I've always been a bit, shall we say, **vertically challenged**, which never really bothered me. On the other hand, my husband, Will, was very **lanky** when he was a teenager, but he's filled out now.

● VOCABULARY

3) **tweezers** /ˈtwiːzəz/ - a small, slim tool used for grasping and removing small objects, such as splinters or hairs

Alex used tweezers to remove a thorn from his finger.

4) **to pluck** /plʌk/ - to pull out hairs with tweezers or your fingers

Jules plucked her eyebrows every week to maintain a neat appearance.

5) **complexion** /kəm'plekʃn/ - the natural colour, texture and appearance of your skin, especially your face

Lots of English people have quite a pale complexion and burn badly in the sun.

6) **sun-kissed** /'sʌn kɪst/ - **tanned** /tænd/ - having a brown skin colour from spending time in the sun

Jane looked like a vision with her summer dress and sun-kissed skin.

7) **vertically challenged** - a funny way to refer to someone who is short

Ruth was only 5 foot tall and often joked about being vertically challenged.

8) **lanky** /'læŋki/ - tall and thin in a slightly awkward way

As a teenager, Benji was lanky and had to grow into his long limbs.

● **EXTRA VOCABULARY**

sticking point /'stɪkɪŋ pɔɪnt/ - an issue or a problem that causes difficulties or concerns

Price is the main sticking point for us. Can you work with us on that?

to fill out /fɪl aʊt/ - to develop in a way that one's body becomes fuller

After many long days in the gym and calorific meals, he began to fill out in ways I'd never seen before.

Now

I'm 29 now, and my worries about my appearance have nearly faded. I very much believe **it's what's on the inside that counts**. If you saw me walking my dog on a wet January morning, I don't think you'd recognise me. I usually look fairly **unkempt**, with **windswept** hair and **scruffy** clothes.

Don't get me wrong, I try to take care of myself, and I think I **scrub up well**. I like putting on make-up for filming and special occasions. One of the things I'm trying to work on appearance-wise is my **posture**. I believe it can change how you feel and how other people perceive you – shoulders back, Lucy!

9) **it's what's on the inside that counts** /ɪts wɒts ɒn ðiː ɪn'saɪd ðæt kaʊnts/ - character and values are more important than looks
She believes that true beauty comes from kindness and compassion; it's what's on the inside that counts.

10) **unkempt** /ʌn'kempt/ - untidy or not properly cared for in appearance.
Tom's unkempt hair and wrinkled clothes made it look like he had just rolled out of bed.

11) **windswept** /'wɪndswɛpt/ - looking like you have been in strong wind, often used to talk about hair
You look a bit windswept! Have you been outside in the storm?

12) **scruffy** /'skrʌfi/ - untidy or dirty in appearance
When I walk my dog, I put on my scruffiest clothes as I know they're going to get muddy.

13) **to scrub up well** /,skrʌb 'ʌp wel/ - to look nice when you make an effort
Pete is usually in shorts and a T-shirt, but he scrubs up well on special occasions.

14) **posture** /'pɒstʃə/ - the position you hold your body in, particularly your neck, shoulders and back when standing or sitting
Grace used to be a dancer, so she has wonderful posture.

Future

Looking far into the future, I can clearly visualise myself and Will. Will's **salt-and-pepper** will be popping, and my hair will be all white! We'll have a lot more **wrinkles**, and there'll be **crow's feet** around our eyes, but I plan to embrace them. They'll tell the story of a lifetime of smiles and laughter and, yes, there'll be frown lines from when our [future!] children do something naughty and stress us out.

15) **salt-and-pepper** /ˌsɔːlt ən 'pepər/ - hair that has two colours mixed together, one dark and one light

Bill's salt-and-pepper beard gave him a distinguished appearance.

Note: we can say **pepper-and-salt**.

16) **wrinkle** /'rɪŋkl/ - a small line on the skin, often caused by ageing

There were fine wrinkles across his forehead that showed the passing years.

17) **crow's feet** /'krəʊz fi:t/ - small lines around the corners of your eyes caused by ageing

Lucy's crow's feet were evidence of a life filled with laughter and joy.

QUIZ!

Choose the correct word from the word bank to complete each sentence.

My family is a blend of unique personalities and characteristics.

First, there's my dad, Bob. His (1) _____ hair makes him look older than he is, and with the few fine (2) _____ that mark his forehead, he exudes an air of wisdom. Those crow's feet around the corners of his eyes become more apparent when he erupts into one of his fits of roaring laughter.

My older sister, Hailey, is the polar opposite of Dad's tall and husky build. She's a bit (3) _____ and scruffy in her appearance, often opting for a laid-back style. But don't let her (4) _____ exterior fool you; she is known to scrub up well when necessary.

Next up is my younger sister, Hannah. She's lanky and in the process of (5) _____ her adolescent frame. With her (6) _____, she meticulously plucks her eyebrows in an attempt to keep up with the latest beauty trends. Her (7) _____ is on the paler side, and she's quick (8) _____ the common misconception that she's sun-deprived.

Last but not least is my mum, Ally. She has an (9) _____ smile that never fails to turn heads. Her (10) _____ appear whenever she smiles, adding to her charm. She has been my biggest role model over the years, and I hope to be half the woman she is when I'm older.

Word Bank

a. wrinkles	b. unkempt	c. salt-and-pepper	d. tweezers	e. complexion
f. vertically challenged	g. to dispel	h. filling out	i. angelic	j. dimples

The End!

1) (2) a (3) f (4) b (5) h (6) d (7) e (8) g (9) i (10) j

